

# KEY TOPIC 3: ELIZABETHAN SOCIETY IN THE AGE OF EXPLORATION, 1558-88

*Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88*

**Scholar:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Class:** \_\_\_\_\_

# PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: \_\_\_\_\_

| Grade                                           | 9-1 GCSE Grading Scale |       |                  |
|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-------|------------------|
| Lesson / Assessment Title                       | Effort                 | Level | Teacher Comments |
| L1: KT3.1: Education and leisure                |                        |       |                  |
| L2: KT3.2: The Problem of Poverty               |                        |       |                  |
| L3: KT3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery |                        |       |                  |
| L4: KT3.4: Raleigh and Virginia                 |                        |       |                  |
| Final Unit Grade:                               |                        |       |                  |

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# L1: KT3.1: Education and leisure

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## LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the purpose of Elizabethan education and the influence of Humanist thinking and the printing press.
- ☐ Analyse how the schooling system (Petty schools, Grammar schools, and Universities) was strictly divided by class and gender.
- ☐ Explain the differences in leisure and sports between the nobility and the lower classes, including the universal popularity of 'cruel sports'.
- ☐ Evaluate the reasons for the sudden explosion of the Elizabethan theatre and why it provoked such fierce opposition from Puritans and city authorities.

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## Do Now Activity

**Score:**    / 10

Who led the Spanish Armada?

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What was the Armada's plan?

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What tactic did the English use to break the Spanish defensive formation at Calais?

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What was the decisive sea battle of the Armada called?

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What role did the weather play in defeating the Armada?

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What did Drake do in Cadiz in 1587?

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When was Mary, Queen of Scots executed?

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What was the Treaty of Nonsuch?

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Who was Francis Walsingham?

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What was the Book of Common Prayer?

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## Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least TWO of the vocabulary words below correctly.

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|---------------------------|
| Grammar School   Pastimes |
|---------------------------|

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## Pair & Share Activity

**Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Did Elizabethan education improve society or simply reinforce class divisions?**

*Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.*

**Your Notes:**

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General Notes

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# GCSE Exam Practice

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**Q2. Describe one feature of education in Elizabethan Grammar Schools.**

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**Q3. Describe one feature of Elizabethan Petty Schools.**

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**Q4. Describe one feature of the Elizabethan theatre.**

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**Q5. Describe one feature of Elizabethan sport and pastimes.**

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**Q6. Explain why there was an increase in the number of schools in early Elizabethan England. Stimulus: Humanism / Growth of trade and business**

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This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.



**Q7. 'The theatre was the most popular form of entertainment for all classes.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: The groundlings / Royal patronage**

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**Q8. 'There was little change in education in Early Elizabethan England.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Petty schools / Education for girls**

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## L2: KT3.2: The Problem of Poverty

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### LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the economic and demographic causes of the poverty crisis, focusing on population growth, inflation, and the devastating impact of enclosure.
- ☐ Analyse contemporary Tudor attitudes towards the poor, specifically the strict division between the 'deserving' (impotent) and 'undeserving' (able-bodied) poor.
- ☐ Explain the reasons behind the public terror of vagabonds.
- ☐ Evaluate the significance of Elizabeth's changing policies, specifically the 1572 Vagabonds Act and the 1576 Poor Relief Act.

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### Do Now Activity

Score:    / 10

Name two types of schools in Elizabethan England.

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What was a typical subject studied at Grammar school?

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What was a popular cruel animal sport during this period?

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Name one famous Elizabethan theatre.

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Were women allowed to act on the Elizabethan stage?

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Who led the Spanish Armada?

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What was the Battle of Gravelines?

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What phrase did Drake use to describe his attack on Cadiz?

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What was the Babington Plot (1586)?

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What was the 'Great Chain of Being'?

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## Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

|                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Vagabond / Vagrant   Enclosure   Impotent Poor   Able-Bodied Poor   Poor Rate</b> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

Your Sentence:

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## Pair & Share Activity

**Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why did poverty increase so rapidly during Elizabeth's reign?**

*Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.*

**Your Notes:**

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General Notes

# GCSE Exam Practice

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**Q2. Describe one feature of the 1572 Vagabonds Act.**

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**Q3. Describe one feature of the 1576 Poor Relief Act.**

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**Q4. Describe one feature of the Houses of Correction.**

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**Q5. Explain why there was an increase in poverty in the years 1558–88. Stimulus:  
Unemployment / Bad harvests**

[12 marks • 15 mins]

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[illegible]

**Q6. 'The main reason for the increase in poverty in the years 1558–88 was the increasing population of England.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Demand for food / Enclosure and sheep farming**

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## L3: KT3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery

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### LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the factors that prompted Elizabethan exploration, focusing on new technology, expanding trade, and privateering.
- ☐ Explain the reasons for, and the immense geopolitical significance of, Francis Drake's circumnavigation of the globe.
- ☐ Analyse the reasons behind Walter Raleigh's attempts to colonise Virginia.
- ☐ Evaluate the intersecting reasons for the catastrophic failure of the Virginia colonies, weighing poor planning against Native American resistance and the Spanish war.

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### Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was a 'vagrant' or 'vagabond'?

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What were the 'deserving poor'?

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What were the 'idle poor'?

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What was the 1572 Vagabonds Act?

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What caused poverty to rise in this period?

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What was a typical subject studied at a Grammar school?

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Were women allowed to act on stage?

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What tactic did the English use to break the Spanish formation at Calais?

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What was a 'privateer'?

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What was the Act of Supremacy?

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## Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Circumnavigation**

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## Pair & Share Activity

**Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: What was the main motivation for Elizabethan exploration?**

*Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.*

**Your Notes:**

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General Notes

# GCSE Exam Practice

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**Q2. Describe one feature of Francis Drake’s circumnavigation of the globe.**

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**Q3. Describe one feature of the impact of new technology on Elizabethan exploration.**

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**Q4. Explain why exploration by the English increased in the years 1558–88. Stimulus:  
Navigational instruments / Drive to expand trade**

[12 marks • 15 mins]

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Blank lined paper for writing.

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**Q5. 'New technology was the main reason why exploration by the English increased in the years 1558–88.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Quadrant and astrolabe / Privateering profits**

[illegible]

**Q6. 'Drake's most significant achievement, in the years 1558–88, was his circumnavigation of the globe.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: The Golden Hind / Raid on Cadiz**

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## L4: KT3.4: Raleigh and Virginia

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### LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the significance of Sir Walter Raleigh in planning, promoting, and financing the Virginia colonies.
- ☐ Analyse the economic, political, and strategic reasons for the attempted colonisation of North America.
- ☐ Evaluate the intersecting reasons for the catastrophic failure of the 1585 and 1587 expeditions, weighing poor planning against Native American resistance and the Spanish Armada.

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### Do Now Activity

**Score:**    / 10

Why did English sailors explore the world?

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What new technology helped Elizabethan exploration?

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Who was the first Englishman to circumnavigate the globe (1577-1580)?

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Who did Elizabeth give a patent to colonize North America in 1584?

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Why did the first Roanoke settlement (1585) fail?

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What happened to the second Roanoke settlement (1587)?

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What caused poverty to rise in the Elizabethan period?

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What was the 1572 Vagabonds Act?

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Who led the Spanish Armada?

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What was the Ridolfi Plot (1571)?

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## Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

|                                                        |
|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Royal Charter   Virginia   Roanoke   Algonquian</b> |
|--------------------------------------------------------|

In 1584, Elizabeth I granted Walter Raleigh a [ . . . . . ] giving him exclusive rights to explore and colonize any lands not held by a Christian prince. Raleigh organized an ambitious expedition to establish a permanent colony in North America, naming the vast territory [ . . . . . ] in honor of the 'Virgin Queen'. The settlers landed on [ . . . . . ] Island, but the colony was doomed by poor planning and increasingly hostile relations with the local [ . . . . . ] Native American tribes, leading to the mysterious disappearance of the colonists.

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## Pair & Share Activity

**Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why did the Roanoke colony fail?**

*Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.*

**Your Notes:**

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General Notes

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# GCSE Exam Practice

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**Q2. Describe one feature of the failure of the first Virginia colony.**

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**Q3. Describe one feature of Sir Walter Raleigh's role in the attempted colonisation of Virginia.**

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**Q4. Explain why the first colony in Virginia failed. Stimulus: Native Americans / Damage to The Tiger**

[12 marks • 15 mins]

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[illegible]

**Q5. Explain why there was an attempt to colonise Virginia in 1585. Stimulus: Sir Walter Raleigh / New trade routes**

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**Q6. 'Poor planning was the main reason why the first colony in Virginia failed.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: The choice of colonists / Lack of food supplies**

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